

SUNITI SOLOMON

1939–2015



Born in Madras, **Dr Suniti Solomon** was a pathologist and microbiologist. She is best-known for having identified the first cases of HIV in India in 1986. At the time, cases of HIV were rising all over the world, but the Indian government was unwilling to consider that the virus could have spread to India. Together with Sellappan Nirmala, a PhD student she was supervising, Solomon began a project to collect and test 100 local blood samples for HIV. The six positives they uncovered were concrete proof that the virus was already present in the population. Solomon subsequently